

CAT 2022 VARC Slot 2 Question Paper with Solutions

Time Allowed :2 Hours	Maximum Marks :198	Total Questions :66
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General Instructions

Read the following instructions very carefully:

1. The total duration of the test is **2 hours**, with **40 minutes** allotted per section.
2. The question paper is divided into **three sections**:
 - **Section 1:** Verbal Ability and Reading Comprehension (VARC) – 24 questions
 - **Section 2:** Data Interpretation and Logical Reasoning (DILR) – 20 questions
 - **Section 3:** Quantitative Aptitude (QA) – 22 questions
3. Each correct answer carries **+3 marks**.
4. For multiple-choice questions (MCQs), **–1 mark** will be deducted for each wrong answer.
5. There is **no negative marking** for Type-in-the-Answer (TITA) questions.
6. Once the allotted time for a section ends, you will automatically move to the next section. You cannot go back to a previous section.
7. All answers must be entered on the computer screen using the mouse and keyboard. Rough sheets will be provided.
8. The use of calculators, mobile phones, or any other electronic device is strictly prohibited. An on-screen basic calculator will be provided.

1. Comprehension: The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The Chinese have two different concepts of a copy. Fanghchin ... are imitations where the difference from the original is obvious. These are small models or copies that can be purchased in a museum shop, for example. The second concept for a copy is Izhujin ... They are exact reproductions of the original, which, for the Chinese, are equal in value to the original. It has absolutely no negative connotations. The discrepancy with regard to the understanding of what a copy is often led to misunderstandings and arguments between China and Western museums. The Chinese often send copies abroad instead of originals, in the firm belief that they are not essentially different from the originals. The rejection that then comes from the Western museums is perceived by the Chinese as an insult ...

The Far Eastern notion of identity is also very confusing to the Western observer. The Ise Grand Shrine [in Japan] is 1,300 years old for millions of Japanese people who go there on pilgrimage every year. But in reality this temple complex is completely rebuilt from scratch every 20 years ... The cathedral of Freiburg Minster in southwest Germany is covered in scaffolding almost all year round. The sandstone from which it is built is a very soft, porous material that does not withstand natural erosion by rain and wind. After a while, it crumbles. As a result, the cathedral is continually being examined for damage, and eroded stones are replaced. And in the cathedral's decorative workshop, copies of the damaged sandstones are constantly being produced. Of course, attempts are made to preserve the stones from the Middle Ages for as long as possible. But at some point they, too, are removed and replaced with new stones.

Fundamentally, this is the same operation as with the Japanese shrine, except in this case the production of a replica takes place very slowly and over long periods of time ... In the field of art as well, the idea of an unassailable original developed historically in the Western world. Back in the 17th century [in the West], excavated artworks from antiquity were treated quite differently from today. They were not restored in a way that was faithful to the original. Instead, there was massive intervention in these works, changing their appearance ...

It is probably this intellectual position that explains why Asians have far fewer scruples about cloning than Europeans. The South Korean cloning researcher Hwang Woo-suk, who attracted worldwide attention with his cloning experiments in 2004, is a Buddhist. He found a great deal of support among other Buddhists, including with Christians called a backlash against human cloning. Hwang legitimized his cloning experiments with his religious affiliation: "I am Buddhist, and I have no philosophical problem with cloning. And as you know, the basis of Buddhism is that life is recycled through reincarnation. In some ways, I think therapeutic cloning restarts the circle of life."

Which one of the following scenarios is unlikely to follow from the arguments in the passage?

- (a) A 17th-century British painter would have no problem adding personal touches when restoring an ancient Roman painting.
- (b) A 17th-century French artist who adhered to a Christian worldview would need to be completely true to the original intent of a painting when restoring it.
- (c) A 20th-century Japanese Buddhist monk would value a reconstructed shrine as the original.
- (d) A 21st-century Christian scientist is likely to oppose cloning because of his philosophical orientation.

Correct Answer: (b) A 17th-century French artist who adhered to a Christian worldview would need to be completely true to the original intent of a painting when restoring it.

Solution: The passage explains that in the 17th-century Western world, restoration was not strictly faithful to the original — artists often made significant changes to ancient artworks. This directly contradicts the scenario in option (b), which assumes that a 17th-century Christian artist would adhere strictly to the original. - Option (a) is consistent with the passage because Western restoration in the 17th century often involved personal touches. - Option (c) is supported by the passage's explanation of the Japanese Buddhist view of reconstructed shrines being equivalent to originals. - Option (d) is consistent with the passage's suggestion that Christians may oppose cloning due to philosophical beliefs. Since option (b) misrepresents the historical approach described in the passage, it is the *unlikely* scenario.

 Quick Tip

When identifying the *unlikely* scenario, look for statements that contradict the explicit examples or principles stated in the passage, rather than those that are simply absent.

2. Which one of the following statements does not correctly express the similarity between the Ise Grand Shrine and the Freiburg Minster?

- (a) Both are continually undergoing restoration.
- (b) Both were built as places of worship.
- (c) Both will one day be completely rebuilt.
- (d) Both can be regarded as very old structures.

Correct Answer: (a) Both are continually undergoing restoration.

Solution: The passage clarifies that:

- The *Ise Grand Shrine* is completely rebuilt from scratch every 20 years — not continually restored.
- The *Freiburg Minster*, on the other hand, undergoes constant restoration and replacement of eroded stones, which is indeed continual.

Thus, while both share similarities — being places of worship (b), being regarded as old despite reconstruction (d), and having replacement or rebuilding processes (c) — they differ in the process. The shrine is rebuilt periodically in full, whereas the Minster is restored continuously in small parts.

Hence, statement (a) is incorrect as a similarity because it applies only to the Minster, not to the shrine.

 Quick Tip

When comparing similarities, ensure that the trait applies equally to both subjects. A characteristic that applies only to one of them cannot be counted as a shared similarity.

3. The value that the modern West assigns to "an unassailable original" has resulted in all of the following EXCEPT:

- (a) It discourages them from simultaneous displays of multiple copies of a painting.
- (b) It allows regular employment for certain craftsmen.
- (c) It discourages them from making interventions in ancient art.
- (d) It discourages them from carrying out human cloning.

Correct Answer: (d) It discourages them from carrying out human cloning.

Solution: The passage's discussion of the Western notion of an "unassailable original" relates specifically to *art and heritage preservation*, not biotechnology or cloning.

- Option (a) is implied — valuing a single original discourages displaying multiple identical copies.
- Option (b) is supported — craftsmen are employed to make faithful replacements (e.g., Freiburg Minster's stonemasons).
- Option (c) is consistent — modern Western restoration avoids major interventions in ancient art, in contrast to the 17th century.
- Option (d) is unrelated — attitudes toward human cloning in the passage are linked to religious and philosophical beliefs (Christian vs. Buddhist), not to the Western art concept of originality.

Therefore, (d) is the correct EXCEPT answer.

 Quick Tip

When a question asks for an *EXCEPT* option, eliminate the ones directly supported by the passage and choose the one that is unrelated or contradicted by the text.

4. Based on the passage, which one of the following copies would a Chinese museum be unlikely to consider as having less value than the original?

- (a) Pablo Picasso's painting of Vincent van Gogh's original painting, identical in every respect.
- (b) Pablo Picasso's miniaturised, but otherwise faithful and accurate painting of Vincent van Gogh's original painting.
- (c) Pablo Picasso's painting of Vincent van Gogh's original painting, bearing Picasso's signature.
- (d) Pablo Picasso's photograph of Vincent van Gogh's original painting, printed to exactly the same scale.

Correct Answer: (a) Pablo Picasso's painting of Vincent van Gogh's original painting, identical in every respect.

Solution: The passage states that the Chinese distinguish between two kinds of copies: 1. Fanghchin — obvious imitations, often smaller or visibly different from the original. 2. Fuzhipin — exact reproductions, considered *equal in value* to the original, without any negative connotation.

Among the given options: - Option (a) fits the definition of **fuzhipin** — an exact, identical reproduction — hence the Chinese would value it the same as the original. - Option (b) is a miniaturised version, so it would fall into the **fanghchin** category and be valued less. - Option (c) has Picasso’s personal signature, making it artistically different, hence not valued equally to the original. - Option (d), while the same scale, is a different medium (photograph), so it is not identical in material and execution. Thus, (a) is the only copy they would not consider less valuable than the original.

 Quick Tip

When interpreting cultural concepts, focus on the exact criteria given in the passage. Here, the Chinese concept of *fuzhipin* demands perfect replication in every respect for equal valuation.

5. Comprehension: The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Stoicism was founded in 300 BC by the Greek philosopher Zeno and survived into the Roman era until about AD 300. According to the Stoics, emotions consist of two movements. The first movement is the immediate feeling and other reactions (e.g., physiological responses) that occur when a stimulus or event occurs. For instance, consider what could have happened if an army general accused Marcus Aurelius of treason in front of other officers. The first movement for Marcus might have been (internal) surprise and anger in response to this insult, accompanied perhaps by some involuntary physiological and expressive responses such as face flushing and a movement of the eyebrows. The second movement is what one does next about the emotion—how one reacts after the initial reaction under one’s control. Examples of second movements for Marcus might have included a plea to save his life, signs of revenge, actions signifying deference and appeasement, or perhaps proceeding as he would have proceeded whether or not this event occurred, continuing to lead the Romans in a way that Marcus Aurelius believed best benefited them. In the Stoic view, choosing a reasoned, unemotional response as the second movement is the only appropriate response.

The Stoics believed that to live the good life and be a good person, we need to free ourselves of nearly all desires such as too much desire for money, power, or sexual gratification. Prior to second movements, we can consider what is important in life. Money, power, and excessive sexual gratification are not important. Character, rationality, and kindness are important. The Epicureans, first associated with the Greek philosopher Epicurus, were simpler in their approach, believing that people should enjoy simple pleasures, such as good conversation, friendship, food, and wine, but not be indulgent in these pursuits and not follow passion for those things that hold no real value like power and money. As Outley (2004) states, “the Epicureans articulated a view—enjoyment of relationship with friends, of things that are real rather than illusory, and of simple pleasures.” This view is somewhat similar to modern ideas of mindfulness, though it is certainly very different today. In sum, these ancient Greek and Roman philosophers saw emotions, especially strong ones, as potentially dangerous. They viewed emotions as experiences that needed to be [reined] in and controlled.

As Outley (2004) points out, the Stoic idea bears some similarity to Buddhism. Buddha, living in India in the 6th century BC, argued for cultivating a certain attitude that decreases

the probability (in Stoic terms) of destructive second movements. Through meditation and the right attitude, one allows emotions to happen to oneself (it is impossible to prevent this), but one is advised to observe the emotions without necessarily acting on them; one achieves some distance and decides what has value and what does not have value. Additionally, the Stoic ideal of developing virtue in oneself, because of being a good person, which the Stoics believed we could do because we have a touch of the divine, laid the foundation for the three monotheistic religions: Judaism, Christianity, and Islam ... As with Stoicism, tenets of these religions include controlling our emotions lest we engage in sinful behavior.

”Through meditation and the right attitude, one allows emotions to happen to oneself (it is impossible to prevent this), but one is advised to observe the emotions without necessarily acting on them; one achieves some distance and decides what has value and what does not have value.” In the context of the passage, which one of the following is *not* a possible implication of the quoted statement?

- (a) Meditation allows certain out-of-body experiences that permit us to gain the distance necessary to control our emotions.
- (b) The observation of emotions in a distant manner corresponds to the second movement referred to earlier in the passage.
- (c) ”Meditation and the right attitude,” in this instance, implies an initially passive reception of all experiences.
- (d) Emotional responses can make it difficult to distinguish valuable experiences from valueless experiences.

Correct Answer: (a) Meditation allows certain out-of-body experiences that permit us to gain the distance necessary to control our emotions.

Solution: The quoted statement explains that emotions cannot be stopped from arising but can be *observed without acting upon them*, thereby creating a mental distance that allows reasoned evaluation of what has value.

- Option (b) is consistent: observing emotions before reacting aligns with the Stoic “second movement.”
 - Option (c) is valid: the approach suggests a passive initial acceptance of emotional experiences.
 - Option (d) is also valid: strong emotions can cloud judgment, making the ability to evaluate value important.
 - Option (a) is incorrect because the passage does not mention “out-of-body experiences” — the “distance” is metaphorical (mental detachment), not literal or mystical.
- Therefore, (a) is the only choice not supported or implied by the passage.

Quick Tip

When a question asks for what is *not* implied, focus on spotting options that introduce ideas or interpretations absent from the text, especially when they shift from metaphorical to literal meanings.

6. Which one of the following statements would be an accurate inference from the example of Marcus Aurelius?

- (a) Marcus Aurelius was one of the leaders of the Roman army.
- (b) Marcus Aurelius plotted revenge in his quest for justice.
- (c) Marcus Aurelius was humiliated by the accusation of treason in front of the other officers.
- (d) Marcus Aurelius was a Stoic whose philosophy survived into the Roman era.

Correct Answer: (a) Marcus Aurelius was one of the leaders of the Roman army.

Solution: The example describes Marcus Aurelius being accused of treason *in front of other officers* by an army general. This context implies that Marcus Aurelius held a position of military leadership (likely a commander or high-ranking officer), hence Option (a) is a safe inference.

- Option (b) is incorrect: the passage explicitly lists plotting revenge only as a *possible* second movement, not as something Marcus actually did.

- Option (c) is incorrect: while surprise and anger were part of the first movement, humiliation is not mentioned and cannot be assumed.

- Option (d) is incorrect: although Marcus Aurelius was historically a Stoic philosopher and Roman emperor, the inference must be drawn from the passage's *example*, not from outside knowledge.

Thus, only (a) follows directly from the example provided.

 Quick Tip

When drawing inferences, stick strictly to what is supported by the passage. Avoid importing outside historical facts or making emotional assumptions unless explicitly stated.

7. Which one of the following statements, if false, could be seen as contradicting the facts/arguments in the passage?

- (a) In the Epicurean view, indulging in simple pleasures is not desirable.
- (b) Despite practising meditation and cultivating the right attitude, emotions cannot ever be controlled.
- (c) In the Stoic view, choosing a reasoned, unemotional response as the first movement is an appropriate response to emotional situations.
- (d) The Greek philosopher Zeno survived into the Roman era until about AD 300.

Correct Answer: (a) In the Epicurean view, indulging in simple pleasures is not desirable.

Solution: The passage states that Epicureans valued *simple pleasures* such as friendship, food, wine, and good conversation, but emphasised avoiding *indulgence* in them. This means that the statement in (a) is factually supported by the passage: indulgence is undesirable according to Epicureans.

If (a) were false — implying that Epicureans *did* view indulging in simple pleasures as desirable — it would directly contradict the passage.

- Option (b): The passage never says emotions can “never” be controlled; in fact, Stoicism and Buddhism aim to manage them, so making this false wouldn’t contradict the text directly.

- Option (c): The passage clearly says the “reasoned, unemotional” reaction is the *second movement*, not the first — so this is already false, but its falsehood matches the passage, so it’s not a contradiction.
 - Option (d): The survival into the Roman era applied to Stoicism, not Zeno personally. Making this false wouldn’t contradict the key arguments about Stoicism’s timeline.
- Thus, only (a) — if false — would conflict with the passage’s stated facts.

💡 Quick Tip

When a question asks which statement, if false, contradicts the passage, look for an option that is explicitly stated in the text as true; negating it should clearly oppose the author’s claims.

8. On the basis of the passage, which one of the following statements can be regarded as true?

- (a) The Epicureans believed in controlling all emotions.
- (b) Stoic influences can be seen in multiple religions.
- (c) There were no Stoics in India at the time of the Roman civilisation.
- (d) The Stoics valorised the pursuit of money, power, and sexual gratification.

Correct Answer: (b) Stoic influences can be seen in multiple religions.

Solution: The passage states that “*the Stoic ideal of developing virtue in oneself . . . laid the foundation for the three monotheistic religions: Judaism, Christianity, and Islam.*” This explicitly confirms that Stoic ideas influenced multiple religions, making Option (b) correct.

- Option (a) is incorrect: the passage does not say the Epicureans aimed to control *all* emotions; rather, they sought moderation and avoidance of indulgence in desires of little value.
 - Option (c) is incorrect: the text mentions Buddhism in India and its similarity to Stoicism, but provides no factual claim about the presence or absence of Stoics in India.
 - Option (d) is incorrect: the Stoics explicitly rejected excessive desire for money, power, and sexual gratification, valuing character, rationality, and kindness instead.
- Thus, only Option (b) is directly supported by the information in the passage.

💡 Quick Tip

When the question asks which statement can be “regarded as true,” identify the one that is *explicitly stated* or *strongly implied* in the passage, avoiding speculative or extreme interpretations.

9. Comprehension: The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Stories concerning the Undead have always been with us. From out of the primal darkness of Mankind’s earliest years, come whispers of eerie creatures, not quite alive (or alive in a way

which we can understand), yet not quite dead either. These may have been ancient and primitive delusions that dwelt deep in the surrounding forests and in remote places, or simply those deceased who refused to remain in their tombs and who wandered about the countryside, physically tormenting and frightening those who were still alive. Most were ill-defined, shadowy figures glimpsed in the night beyond the comforting glow of the fire, or a shape, half-glimpsed in the twilight at the edge of settlements. They were vague and indistinct, but they were always there with the power to terrify and disturb. They had the power to touch the minds of our early ancestors and fill them with dread. Such fear formed the basis of the earliest tales although the source and exact nature of such terrors still remained very vague.

And as Mankind became more sophisticated, leaving the gloom of their caves and forming themselves into recognizable communities—towns, cities, whole cultures—the Undead travelled with them, inhabiting their folklore just as they had in former times. Now they began to take on more definite shapes. They became walking cadavers; the physical embodiment of former delusions and things which had existed alongside Man since the Creation. Some still remained vague and ill-defined, but, as Mankind strove to explain the horror which it felt towards them, such creatures emerged more readily into the light.

In order to confirm their abnormal status, many of the Undead were often accorded attributes, which defied the natural order of things—the power to transform themselves into other shapes, the ability to sustain themselves by drinking human blood, and the ability to influence human minds across a distance. Such powers—described as supernatural—only lent [an] added dimension to the terror for humans who regarded them.

And it was only natural, too, that the Undead should become connected with the practice of magic. From very early times, Shamans and witchdoctors had claimed at least some power and control over the spirits of departed ancestors, and this has continued down into more "civilized" times. Formerly, the invisible spirits and forces that thronged around men's earliest encampments, had spoken "through" the tribal Shamans but now, as entities in their own right, they were subject to magical control and could be physically summoned by a competent sorcerer. However, the relationship between the magician and an Undead creature was often a very tenuous and uncertain one. Some sorcerers might have even become Undead entities once they died, but they might also have been susceptible to the powers of other magicians when they did.

From the Middle Ages and into the Age of Enlightenment, theories of the Undead continued to grow and develop. Their names became more familiar—werewolf, vampire, ghoul—each one certain to strike fear into the hearts of ordinary humans

Which one of the following observations is a valid conclusion to draw from the statement, "From out of the primal darkness of Mankind's earliest years, come whispers of eerie creatures, not quite alive (or alive in a way which we can understand), yet not quite dead either"?

- (a) We can understand the lives of the eerie creatures in Mankind's early years through their whispers in the darkness.
- (b) Long ago, eerie creatures used to whisper in the primal darkness that they were not quite alive.
- (c) Mankind's early years were marked by a belief in the existence of eerie creatures that were neither quite alive nor dead.
- (d) Mankind's primal years were marked by creatures alive with eerie whispers, but seen only in the darkness.

Correct Answer: (c) Mankind’s early years were marked by a belief in the existence of eerie creatures that were neither quite alive nor dead.

Solution: The statement describes ancient human fears of “eerie creatures” that occupied an ambiguous state—neither fully alive nor fully dead. The phrase “come whispers” is metaphorical, referring to the presence of such beliefs in humanity’s earliest times, not literal communication from creatures. Therefore, Option (c) correctly captures the intended meaning: in early human history, there was a *belief* in such entities.

- Option (a) is incorrect: it assumes we can understand these creatures’ lives through whispers, which is not supported by the text.
 - Option (b) is incorrect: it literalises the “whispers” as actual speech by creatures, which the passage never claims.
 - Option (d) is incorrect: it misinterprets the description, treating the creatures as definitely alive and physically seen only in darkness, which is not stated.
- Thus, only Option (c) accurately reflects the meaning of the original sentence.

 Quick Tip

Be cautious with figurative language in RC passages. Words like “whispers” or “darkness” may symbolise fear or myth rather than literal actions or settings.

10. All of the following statements, if false, could be seen as being in accordance with the passage, EXCEPT:

- (a) The growing sophistication of Mankind meant that humans stopped believing in the Undead.
- (b) The transition from the Middle Ages to the Age of Enlightenment saw new theories of the Undead.
- (c) The Undead remained vague and ill-defined, even as Mankind strove to understand the horror they inspired.
- (d) The relationship between Shamans and the Undead was believed to be strong and stable one.

Correct Answer: (b) The transition from the Middle Ages to the Age of Enlightenment saw new theories of the Undead.

Solution: The question asks for the statement which, *if false*, would *not* be in accordance with the passage.

- Option (a): The passage states that the Undead continued to be part of folklore as Mankind became more sophisticated, so the claim that belief *stopped* is false and consistent with the passage (belief actually continued).
- Option (c): The text confirms that many Undead remained “vague and ill-defined” despite efforts to explain them, so if this statement were false, it could still fit with the passage’s message.
- Option (d): The passage describes the magician–Undead relationship as “tenuous and uncertain,” so if the claim of a strong and stable relationship were false, that would align with the passage.

- Option (b): The passage explicitly states that “from the Middle Ages and into the Age of Enlightenment, theories of the Undead continued to grow and develop.” If this were false, it would directly contradict the passage. Therefore, this is the *exception*. Thus, Option (b) is the one that, if false, would *not* be in accordance with the passage.

 Quick Tip

For “EXCEPT” questions, mentally flip the logic: identify which choice would directly contradict the passage rather than fit it, even when assumed false.

11. Which one of the following statements best describes what the passage is about?

- (a) The writer describes the ways in which the Undead come to be associated with Shamans and the practice of magic.
- (b) The passage describes the failure of human beings to fully comprehend their environment.
- (c) The writer discusses the transition from primitive thinking to the Age of Enlightenment.
- (d) The passage discusses the evolution of theories of the Undead from primitive thinking to the Age of Enlightenment.

Correct Answer: (d) The passage discusses the evolution of theories of the Undead from primitive thinking to the Age of Enlightenment.

Solution: The passage traces the origins and transformations of beliefs in the Undead—from vague, primal fears in humanity’s earliest years, through their integration into folklore and magic, to the more structured theories that emerged by the Age of Enlightenment.

- Option (a) is too narrow: while the connection between Shamans and the Undead is discussed, it is only a small part of the overall narrative.
- Option (b) misrepresents the focus: the passage is not about a general inability to understand the environment, but specifically about beliefs in the Undead.
- Option (c) is incomplete: although the passage covers a broad historical shift, the central theme is specifically about the Undead, not just human thinking in general.
- Option (d) is accurate and comprehensive: it captures both the subject (theories of the Undead) and the scope (from primitive thinking to the Age of Enlightenment).

Thus, Option (d) best summarises the passage.

 Quick Tip

When a question asks for the “best description” of a passage, ensure your choice covers both the central theme *and* the full time or idea span discussed, without narrowing the focus unnecessarily.

12. ”In order to confirm their abnormal status, many of the Undead were often accorded attributes, which defied the natural order of things ...” Which one of the following best expresses the claim made in this statement?

- (a) The Undead are defined in nature's order by giving them divine attributes.
- (b) According to the Undead, abnormal status is to reject the natural order of things.
- (c) Human beings conceptualise the Undead as possessing abnormal features.
- (d) The natural attributes of the Undead are rendered abnormal by changing their status.

Correct Answer: (c) Human beings conceptualise the Undead as possessing abnormal features.

Solution: The sentence from the passage explains that the Undead were given supernatural powers—such as shapeshifting, drinking blood, and influencing minds—which *defied the natural order of things*.

This is a human act of imagination and attribution, aimed at reinforcing the idea that the Undead are abnormal.

- Option (a) is incorrect: The passage does not mention “divine” attributes; it specifies supernatural powers that break natural laws, not divine qualities.
 - Option (b) is incorrect: It falsely assumes the Undead themselves hold opinions (“According to the Undead”), which the passage never states.
 - Option (c) is correct: The focus is on how humans *conceptualise* or imagine the Undead as having unnatural powers, which aligns exactly with the sentence's meaning.
 - Option (d) is incorrect: It reverses the logic, implying the Undead had natural attributes that were later altered, which the passage does not suggest.
- Thus, Option (c) most accurately captures the claim being made.

Quick Tip

When rephrasing a claim from a passage, focus on *who* is doing the action and *what* the action entails. Avoid options that introduce new actors (e.g., the Undead's own perspective) or concepts not in the text (e.g., divinity).

13. Comprehension: The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Critical theory of technology is a political theory of modernity with a normative dimension. It belongs to a tradition extending from Marx to Foucault and Habermas according to which advances in the formal claims of human rights take center stage while in the background centralization of ever more powerful public institutions and private organizations imposes an authoritarian social order.

Marx attributed this trajectory to the capitalist rationalization of production. Today it marks many institutions besides the factory and every modern political system, including so-called socialist systems. This trajectory arose from the problems of command over a disempowered and deskilled labor force; but everywhere [that] masses are organized—whether it be Foucault's prisons or Habermas' public sphere—the same pattern prevails. Technological design and development is shaped by this pattern as the material base of a distinctive social order. Marcuse would later point to a “project” as the basis of what he called rather “confusingly ‘technological rationality.’” Releasing technology from this project is a democratic political task.

In accordance with this general line of thought, critical theory of technology regards technologies as an environment rather than as a collection of tools. We live today with and even within technologies that determine our way of life. Along with the constant pressures to build centers of power, many other social values and meanings are inscribed in technological design. A hermeneutics of technology must make explicit the meanings implicit in the devices we use. Semiotics, psychoanalysis, and studies of artificial lighting or firearms have made important contributions to this type of analysis. Critical theory of technology attempts to build a methodological approach on the lessons of these histories.

As an environment, technologies shape their inhabitants. In this respect, they are comparable to laws and customs. Each of these institutions can be said to represent those who live under their sway through privileging certain dimensions of their human nature. Laws of property represent the interest in ownership and control. Customs such as parental authority represent the interest of childhood in safety and growth. Similarly, the automobile represents its users in so far as they are interested in mobility. Interests such as these constitute the version of human nature sanctioned by society.

This notion of representation does not imply an eternal human nature. The concept of nature as non-identity suggests an alternative. On these terms, nature is what lies at the limit of history, at that point at which society loses the capacity to imprint its meanings on things and control them effectively. The reference here is, of course, not to the nature of natural science, but to the lived nature in which we find ourselves and which we are. This nature reveals itself as that which cannot be totally explained by the machinery of society. For the Frankfurt School, human nature, in all its transcending force, emerges out of a historical context as that context is [depicted] in illicit joys, struggles and pathologies. We can perhaps admit a less romantic . . . conception in which those dimensions of human nature recognized by society are also granted theoretical legitimacy.

Which one of the following statements contradicts the arguments of the passage?

- (a) The problems of command over a disempowered and deskilled labour force gave rise to similar patterns of the capitalist rationalisation of production wherever masses were organised.
- (b) Paradoxically, the capitalist rationalisation of production is a mark of so-called socialist systems as well.
- (c) Marx's understanding of the capitalist rationalisation of production and Marcuse's understanding of a "project" of "technological rationality" share theoretical inclinations.
- (d) Masses are organised in patterns set by Foucault's prisons and Habermas' public sphere.

Correct Answer: (c) Marx's understanding of the capitalist rationalisation of production and Marcuse's understanding of a "project" of "technological rationality" share theoretical inclinations.

Solution: The question asks for the statement that *contradicts* the arguments of the passage.

- Option (a) is supported: The passage states that the trajectory of capitalist rationalisation arose from the problems of command over a disempowered and deskilled labour force and that this pattern appears wherever masses are organised.
- Option (b) is supported: The passage explicitly notes that the same pattern "marks many institutions besides the factory and every modern political system, including so-called socialist systems."
- Option (d) is supported: The passage states that "everywhere masses are organized—whether it be Foucault's prisons or Habermas' public sphere—the same pattern prevails."

- Option (c) contradicts the passage: The text presents Marx’s analysis and later mentions Marcuse’s “project” of “technological rationality” as a separate, not identical, framework, even noting that Marcuse’s term is “rather confusing.” It does not claim they share theoretical inclinations; treating them as equivalent misrepresents the argument. Thus, Option (c) is the statement that contradicts the arguments of the passage.

 Quick Tip

For “contradicts the passage” questions, actively look for claims that falsely equate distinct ideas or frameworks, as these often signal the correct choice.

14. Which one of the following statements could be inferred as supporting the arguments of the passage?

- (a) The romantic conception of nature referred to by the passage is the one that requires theoretical legitimacy.
- (b) Nature decides the point at which society loses its capacity to control history.
- (c) It is not human nature, but human culture that is represented by institutions such as law and custom.
- (d) Technologies form the environmental context and shape the contours of human society.

Correct Answer: (a) The romantic conception of nature referred to by the passage is the one that requires theoretical legitimacy.

Solution: The passage explains that the Frankfurt School’s romantic view of human nature emerges from historical contexts and is depicted in illicit joys, struggles, and pathologies. However, the author suggests a *less romantic* view in which the dimensions of human nature recognized by society are also given *theoretical legitimacy*.

Thus, a statement supporting the argument would affirm that even the romantic conception—already acknowledged in the passage—deserves this legitimacy.

- Option (a) fits because it directly relates to the idea that conceptions of human nature (including romantic ones) should be theoretically recognized.
- Option (b) is incorrect: The passage states that *nature is what lies at the limit of history* when society loses control, but it does not personify nature as making a decision.
- Option (c) is incorrect: The passage explicitly says laws and customs represent certain *dimensions of human nature*, not culture instead of nature.
- Option (d) is incorrect: While the passage does compare technologies to an environment shaping human life, the question asks for a statement supporting the *overall arguments*, which focus more on the nature–society–technology interplay and legitimacy of conceptions of human nature.

Thus, Option (a) is the best supporting inference.

 Quick Tip

When asked for a “supporting” statement, look for options that align with the author’s evaluative stance, not just factual points from the text.

15. Which one of the following statements best reflects the main argument of the fourth paragraph?

- (a) Automobiles represent the interest in mobility present in human nature.
- (b) Technology, laws, and customs are not unlike each other if considered as institutions.
- (c) Technology, laws, and customs are comparable, but dissimilar phenomena.
- (d) Technological environments privilege certain dimensions of human nature as effectively as laws and customs.

Correct Answer: (b) Technology, laws, and customs are not unlike each other if considered as institutions.

Solution: The fourth paragraph draws an explicit comparison between *technologies*, *laws*, and *customs*, describing all of them as institutions that “represent” people by privileging certain aspects of their human nature. Examples are provided:

- Laws of property → interest in ownership and control.
- Parental authority → interest of childhood in safety and growth.
- Automobiles → interest in mobility.

The point is not just to note similarities, but to classify them together as institutions shaping human interests.

- Option (a) is incorrect: While true, it reflects only an example from the paragraph, not its main argument.
 - Option (b) is correct: It captures the central claim—that technology, laws, and customs share a similar institutional role in shaping human interests.
 - Option (c) is incorrect: The paragraph emphasises similarity, not dissimilarity.
 - Option (d) is incorrect: Although true in spirit, it focuses only on technology, while the main argument covers all three (technology, laws, customs) equally.
- Thus, Option (b) summarises the paragraph’s primary message.

 Quick Tip

When identifying the main argument of a paragraph, avoid getting distracted by examples or narrower points—look for the common thread uniting all details presented.

16. All of the following claims can be inferred from the passage, EXCEPT:

- (a) Analyses of technologies must engage with their social histories to be able to reveal their implicit and explicit meanings for us.
- (b) Technologies seek to privilege certain dimensions of human nature at a high cost to lived nature.
- (c) The critical theory of technology argues that, as issues of human rights become more prominent, we lose sight of the ways in which the social order becomes more authoritarian.
- (d) The significance of parental authority to children’s safety does not therefore imply that parental authority is a permanent aspect of human nature.

Correct Answer: (b) Technologies seek to privilege certain dimensions of human nature at a high cost to lived nature.

Solution: The passage contains multiple ideas that can be reasonably inferred:

- Option (a) is supported: In paragraph 2, the author states that critical theory of technology “must make explicit the meanings implicit in the devices we use” and that this draws on “the lessons of these histories,” showing the link between technological analysis and social history.
 - Option (c) is supported: Paragraph 1 explains that human rights discourse takes center stage while “in the background” more powerful institutions impose authoritarian order—this matches the statement.
 - Option (d) is supported: Paragraph 4 makes it clear that representation by institutions does not imply an “eternal human nature,” hence parental authority is not a permanent trait.
 - Option (b) is *not* supported: The passage says technologies privilege certain dimensions of human nature (e.g., mobility, ownership), but nowhere does it state or imply that this occurs “at a high cost to lived nature.” The text defines lived nature as something society cannot fully control, but does not frame technological privileging as harmful to it.
- Thus, Option (b) is the statement that cannot be inferred and is therefore the correct answer.

 Quick Tip

For EXCEPT questions, confirm that each supported option has clear textual evidence; reject any that add extra claims (like “at a high cost”) that are not explicitly or implicitly stated.

17. The four sentences (labelled 1, 2, 3, and 4) below, when properly sequenced, would yield a coherent paragraph. Decide on the proper sequencing of the order of the sentences and key in the sequence of the four numbers as your answer.

1. Fish skin collagen has excellent thermo-stability and tensile strength making it ideal for use as bandage that adheres to the skin and adjusts to body movements.
2. Collagen, one of the main structural proteins in connective tissues in the human body, is well known for promoting skin regeneration.
3. Fish skin swims in here as diseases and bacteria that affect fish are different from most human pathogens.
4. The risk of introducing disease agents into other species through the use of pig and bovine-derived proteins for wound healing has inhibited its broader applications in the medical field.

Correct Answer: 2431

Solution: The paragraph logically begins with a general introduction to collagen (Sentence 2), explaining its role in promoting skin regeneration. Next, Sentence 4 presents a problem: the risk of disease transmission from pig and bovine-derived collagen in wound healing. Sentence 3 offers the solution — fish skin collagen is safer because fish pathogens differ from human pathogens. Finally, Sentence 1 gives specific advantages of fish skin collagen (thermo-stability, tensile strength) and its ideal use as a bandage. Thus, the coherent sequence is $2 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 1$.

 Quick Tip

For para-jumble questions, identify the opening definition or general statement, follow it with the problem, then the solution, and end with supporting details.

18. The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

All that we think we know about how life hangs together is really some kind of illusion that we have projected onto ourselves because of our limited vision. What appear to be inanimate objects such as stones turn out not only to be alive in the same way that we are, but also in more infinite ways to be affected by stimuli just as humans are. The distinction between animate and inanimate simply cannot be made when you enter the world of quantum mechanics and try to determine how those apparent subatomic particles, of which you and everything else in our universe is composed, are all tied together. The point is that physics and metaphysics show there is a pattern to the universe that goes beyond our capacity to grasp it with our brains.

- (a) Quantum physics indicates that an astigmatic view of reality results in erroneous assumptions about the universe.
- (b) The inanimate world is both sentient and cognizant like its animate counterpart.
- (c) The effect of stimuli is similar in inanimate objects when compared to animate objects or living beings.
- (d) Arbitrary distinctions between inanimate and animate objects disappear at the scale at which quantum mechanics works.

Correct Answer: (d) Arbitrary distinctions between inanimate and animate objects disappear at the scale at which quantum mechanics works.

Solution: The passage's central claim is that our usual division between animate and inanimate is an illusion — quantum mechanics shows that all matter, including what we call “inanimate” objects, is interconnected and responsive in ways similar to living things. The focus is on the *disappearance of the animate–inanimate distinction* at the quantum level.

- Option (a) is too vague and focuses on “erroneous assumptions” without addressing the animate–inanimate distinction central to the passage.
- Option (b) overstates by asserting “both sentient and cognizant,” which the passage does not claim.
- Option (c) narrows the focus only to stimuli-response similarity, missing the broader philosophical point.
- Option (d) directly captures the essence — that the distinction between animate and inanimate dissolves in the framework of quantum mechanics.

Thus, Option (d) is the best summary.

 Quick Tip

When summarising, identify the single unifying insight of the passage and avoid options that either exaggerate claims or focus on only one example.

19. The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

It is not that modern historians of medieval Africa have been ignorant about contacts between Ethiopia and Europe; they just had the power dynamic reversed. The traditional narrative stressed Ethiopia as weak and in trouble in the face of aggression from external forces, so Ethiopia sought military assistance from their fellow Christians to the north. But the real story, buried in plain sight in medieval diplomatic texts, simply had not been put together by modern scholars. Recent research pushes us to imagine a much more richly connected medieval world, including the evidence that the kings of Ethiopia were sponsoring their own missions of diplomacy, faith, and commerce.

- (a) Medieval texts have been 'cherry-picked' to promote a view of Ethiopia as weak and in need of Europe's military help with aggressive neighbours, but recent studies reveal it was a well-connected and outward-looking culture.
- (b) Historians were under the illusion that Ethiopia needed military protection from their neighbours, but in fact the country had close commercial and religious connections with them.
- (c) Medieval historical sources selectively promoted the narrative that powerful European forces were called on to protect weak African civilizations such as Ethiopia, but this is far from reality.
- (d) Medieval texts have documented how strong connections between the Christian communities of Ethiopia and Europe were invaluable in establishing military and trade links between the two civilizations.

Correct Answer: (a) Medieval texts have been 'cherry-picked' to promote a view of Ethiopia as weak and in need of Europe's military help with aggressive neighbours, but recent studies reveal it was a well-connected and outward-looking culture.

Solution: The author states that historians have not been unaware of Ethiopia–Europe contact, but have misrepresented the power balance — portraying Ethiopia as weak and dependent. Recent evidence from medieval diplomatic texts shows Ethiopia as actively engaging in diplomacy, faith, and commerce, which contradicts the old narrative. - Option (a)

captures both the misrepresentation ("cherry-picked" portrayal of weakness) and the updated reality (outward-looking, well-connected Ethiopia). - Option (b) incorrectly says Ethiopia had "close connections with neighbours," which is not the focus — the connections discussed are with Europe. - Option (c) omits the idea of active Ethiopian missions and simply says the narrative is false without giving the new perspective. - Option (d) focuses only on Christian connections and trade, ignoring the distortion in the older narrative.

Thus, Option (a) best reflects the passage.

 Quick Tip

For summary questions, ensure the option includes both (1) the original mistaken belief and (2) the new evidence or reinterpretation, not just one of them.

20. The four sentences (labelled 1, 2, 3, and 4) below, when properly sequenced, would yield a coherent paragraph. Decide on the proper sequencing of the order of the sentences and key in the sequence of the four numbers as your answer.

1. The creative element in product design has become of paramount importance as it is one of the few ways a firm or industry can sustain a competitive advantage over its rivals.
2. In fact, the creative element in the value of world industry would be larger still, if we added the contribution of the creative element in other industries, such as the design of tech accessories.
3. The creative industry is receiving a lot of attention today as its growth rate is faster than that of the world economy as a whole.
4. It is for this reason that today's trade issues are increasingly involving intellectual property, as Western countries have an interest in protecting their revenues along with freer trade in non-tangibles.

Correct Answer: 3214

Solution: The logical flow begins with Sentence 3, which introduces the creative industry and its rapid growth compared to the world economy.

Next, Sentence 2 expands on its value by noting the added contributions of creative design in other sectors.

Sentence 1 narrows the focus to the role of creativity in product design as a competitive advantage.

Finally, Sentence 4 draws the consequence: this centrality of creativity makes intellectual property a major trade issue for Western nations.

Thus, the coherent sequence is $3 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 4$.

 Quick Tip

When arranging sentences, look for: (1) broad introduction, (2) expansion or quantification, (3) specific example or focus, (4) concluding implication or consequence.

21. The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

Petitioning is an expedient democratic tradition, used frequently in prior centuries, by which citizens can bring issues directly to governments. As expressions of collective voice, they support procedural democracy by shaping agendas. They can also recruit citizens to causes, give voice to the voiceless, and apply the discipline of rhetorical argument that clarifies a point of view. By contrast, elections are limited in several respects: they involve only a few

candidates, and thus fall far short of representative democracy. Further, voters' choices are not specific to particular policies or laws, and elections are episodic, whereas the voice of the people needs to be heard and integrated constantly into democratic government.

- (a) By giving citizens greater control over shaping political and democratic agendas, political petitions are invaluable as they represent an ideal form of a representative democracy.
- (b) Petitioning has been important to democratic functioning, as it supplements the electoral process by enabling ongoing engagement with the government.
- (c) Petitioning is definitely more representative of the collective voice, and the functioning of democratic government could improve if we relied more on petitioning rather than holding periodic elections.
- (d) Citizens become less inclined to petitioning as it enables vocal citizens to shape political agendas, but this needs to change to strengthen democracies today.

Correct Answer: (b) Petitioning has been important to democratic functioning, as it supplements the electoral process by enabling ongoing engagement with the government.

Solution: The passage compares petitioning and elections, highlighting petitioning's strengths: it shapes agendas, gives voice to marginalized groups, and ensures continuous citizen engagement—contrasting with elections' episodic and limited nature. The author does not argue that petitioning replaces elections or that it is the “ideal form” of democracy, but rather that it *supplements* electoral democracy.

- Option (a) overstates by calling petitioning “ideal representative democracy,” which the passage does not claim.
- Option (b) correctly summarizes the passage as petitioning being an important complement to elections, ensuring ongoing citizen input.
- Option (c) is prescriptive and biased (“could improve if we relied more”), which the passage does not state.
- Option (d) introduces a claim about citizens being less inclined to petitioning, which is absent from the text.

Thus, Option (b) is the most accurate summary.

 Quick Tip

When summarising, avoid adding prescriptive recommendations or speculative claims unless the passage itself clearly does so.

22. The four sentences (labelled 1, 2, 3, and 4) below, when properly sequenced, would yield a coherent paragraph. Decide on the proper sequencing of the order of the sentences and key in the sequence of the four numbers as your answer.

1. Some company leaders are basing their decisions on locating offices to foster innovation and growth, as their best-performing inventors suffered the greatest productivity losses when their commutes grew longer.
2. Shorter commutes support innovation by giving employees more time in the office and greater opportunities for in-person collaboration, while removing the physical strain of a long commute.
3. This is not always the case: remote work does not automatically lead to greater creativity or productivity as office water-cooler conversations are also very important for innovation.

4. Some see the link between long commutes and productivity as support for work-from-home scenarios, as many workers have grown accustomed to their commute-free arrangements during the pandemic.

Correct Answer: 2143

Solution: The paragraph starts with Sentence 2, a general claim about the benefits of shorter commutes on innovation and productivity.

Sentence 1 supports this with an example of company leaders making office-location decisions based on commute length's effect on top inventors. Sentence 4 then presents an alternative view—some interpret the commute-productivity link as evidence in favor of remote work. Sentence 3 qualifies that remote work is not always better for creativity, as in-person interactions also drive innovation.

Thus, the logical sequence is $2 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 3$.

 Quick Tip

For para-jumble problems, start with the broad statement, follow with examples or evidence, then bring in contrasting perspectives, and end with a qualification or resolution.

23. There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: Having made citizens more knowledgeable than their predecessors, the Internet has proved to be both a blessing and a curse.

Never before has a population, nearly all of whom has enjoyed at least a secondary school education, been exposed to so much information, whether in newspapers and magazines or through YouTube, Google, and Facebook. (1) Yet it is not clear if people today are any wiser or more knowledgeable than their barely literate predecessors. Contemporary advances in technology offer more serious and inquisitive students access to realms of knowledge previously unimaginable and unavailable. (2) But such readily available knowledge leads many more students away from serious study, the reading of actual texts, and toward an inability to write effectively and grammatically. (3) It has let people choose sources that reinforce their opinions rather than encouraging them to question inherited beliefs. (4)

Correct Answer: Option 4

Solution: The sentence about the Internet being both a blessing and a curse functions as a concluding reflection—it summarises the dual nature discussed in the paragraph: - Blessing: unprecedented access to information and knowledge. - Curse: distractions, poor writing skills, and confirmation bias.

Placing it after Blank 4 allows it to encapsulate all the examples given earlier. - Option 1 would interrupt the flow before the author questions whether people are truly wiser. - Option

2 would disrupt the contrast between opportunity and misuse. - Option 3 would break the sequence of negative effects before the final one is introduced.
Thus, Option 4 is most coherent.

 Quick Tip

For “best fit” questions, check whether the missing sentence is transitional, elaborative, or conclusive—its role will guide you to the right blank.

24. There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: Easing the anxiety and pressure of having a “big day” is part of the appeal for many couples who marry in secret.

Wedding season is upon us and — after two years of Covid chaos that saw numbers scale back — you may think the temptation would be to go all out. (1) But instead of expanding the guest list, many couples are opting for entirely secret ceremonies. With Covid case numbers remaining high and the cost of living crisis meaning that many couples are feeling the pinch, it’s no wonder that some are less than eager to send out invites. (2) Plus, it can’t hurt that in celebrity circles getting married in secret is all the rage. (3) “I would definitely say that secret weddings are becoming more common,” says Laci J. Bejar, the founder of a therapy practice, which specializes in helping brides and grooms manage wedding stress. “People looking for ways to get out of the spotlight and avoid the hype and circumstance of weddings. (4) They just want to get to the part where they are married.”

Correct Answer: Option 2

Solution: The given sentence explains a specific emotional motivation—reducing anxiety and pressure—which logically fits after mentioning financial and health concerns.

- Placing it in Blank 2 creates a smooth cause-effect flow:

(a) Covid and cost-of-living pressures discourage big weddings →

(b) emotional relief from avoiding the “big day” hype →

(c) trend reinforced by celebrity examples (Sentence 3).

- Option 1 would break the initial contrast between “going all out” and “opting for secret ceremonies.”

- Option 3 would awkwardly separate the celebrity trend from its description.

- Option 4 would disrupt the quotation’s flow, making it unclear if the inserted sentence is part of the speaker’s words.

Thus, Option 2 is the most logical placement.

 Quick Tip

When inserting a sentence, read both before and after the blank—correct placement should feel seamless and preserve the logical and narrative flow.

